

Meoncross School History Department

MARKING & FEEDBACK POLICY

Revised for 2026-2027

Rationale

The History Department prioritizes meaningful, manageable, and motivating feedback by focusing on the impact of teacher interventions rather than performative volume. In line with this, the department has shifted its primary focus toward handwritten work completed directly in pupil printed workbooks.

Formal assessments are recorded centrally, while individual feedback is delivered through live verbal coaching and whole-class modelling to ensure student effort is redirected into active reflection and improvement rather than administrative record-keeping.

Centring Pupil Voice

Feedback is a two-way dialogue, not a monologue. Our policy is fundamentally driven by **Pupil Voice**. Throughout all lessons, live marking requires pupils to vocalize their understanding and misconceptions during teacher coaching. Furthermore, at the end of every unit, pupils complete structured reflections to explicitly voice what they found engaging or challenging, directly informing and adapting future teacher planning.

Presentation & Workbooks

This year, the history department is trialling A4 workbooks for all year groups. This is to reduce the reliance on loose worksheets and the time spent managing traditional exercise books. By pairing these structured workbooks with our bespoke digital learning app, we create a unified system: the app drives retrieval practice and interactive revision, while the workbook provides a permanent, high-quality physical record for extended writing and core knowledge.

Frequency of Marking

Key Stage 3

Teachers will provide two pieces of feedback-focused homework each half term: one 'Read Out Loud' task (self-graded on Teams) to support literacy across the curriculum, and one short written piece graded by the teacher using the KS3 levels. In line with DfE and EEF workload guidance, routine classwork is not formally marked or stamped; instead, teacher time is reinvested into high-quality planning and live, in-the-moment verbal feedback during lessons.

Key Stage 4

At Key Stage 4, there is increased flexibility in assessment methods depending on the unit being studied. Generally, this involves ongoing, low-stakes informal assessment conducted at regular intervals in class. Feedback is primarily delivered verbally, focusing on teacher modelling of answers and exam technique, with a particular emphasis on source-based questions.

To ensure progress is monitored effectively, a formal tracking sheet is utilized within Teams Assignments. This includes CAT4 target grades, which serve as a minimum target rate with the clear aspiration for pupils to exceed them. Consequently, there is no requirement for formal written marking or acknowledgment of daily classwork in exercise books, maximizing the impact of targeted exam technique interventions.

Types of Marking & Feedback

Marking in the Moment / Live Marking

Intervention marking within the lesson to prompt deeper thinking and swiftly address misconceptions. This takes place in the form of verbal feedback and occurs through effective questioning to clarify or refocus tasks. **Crucially, this is where Pupil Voice is first captured, as students must verbally respond to and articulate their reflections.**

Improvement Marking

Verbal feedback will be given alongside an opportunity to respond in order to strengthen the teaching and learning process and accelerate and deepen learning.

Self-Assessment and Peer Assessment

Pupils will be given opportunities to mark their own/peers' work or assess themselves against a provided success criteria. This will sometimes be led by the class teacher, but there will also be opportunities for children to mark autonomously (i.e., against a checklist). Where there is peer-marking, the teacher will then corroborate scores.

End of Unit Assessments & Pupil Voice

Written feedback is based on success criteria or a formal mark scheme. It may refer to the target set from the previous assessment and should include next steps/targets for development. Positive comments/praise/stickers should be used to celebrate success. Results may be in the form of a numerical score, a Progress Category, or a GCSE Grade.

END OF UNIT PUPIL VOICE

Following the assessment, pupils are directed to the **Pupil Reflection Area** in their workbooks. During this time, they engage in a formal **Pupil Voice reflection exercise**. They must document how they felt about the unit, voice any ongoing challenges, and reflect on their own effort. This ensures that their voice is permanently recorded in their workbooks and acts as a direct feedback loop for the teacher.

Automated Marking (Bespoke App / Digital Platforms)

When teachers set online homework using our custom history app or other platforms that automatically mark pupil work, the teacher is responsible for making sure that the tasks chosen are appropriate for every pupil and that pupils know how to make good use of the available feedback. The teacher will keep a record of pupil results as directed by the Head of Department, monitoring quality and making interventions to ensure completion.

Standards & Grading

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (SPaG)

We follow the English department's marking guide to set clear and consistent standards and to support pupils' familiarity with the following symbols:

Symbol	Meaning
Sp	Incorrect spelling
P	Punctuation issue
G	Grammar problem
C	Capital letter needed
//	New paragraph needed
^	Word omitted
?	The meaning is unclear
!	Basic error
?	Good point
??	Exceptional point / insight

Feedback Expectations & Pupil Reflection

In the feedback lessons, pupils should actively review teacher feedback and use the designated **Lesson Reflection** elements and **Pupil Reflection Area** to enact improvements directly in their workbooks. This is an active, vocal process where Pupil

Voice is encouraged as students query their feedback and articulate how they intend to improve.

Assessment & Grading Framework

Moderation and Monitoring

The Head of Department is responsible for ensuring the quality of assessment marking by creating mark schemes and directing effective moderation. Following marking and moderation, the teacher will keep a record of pupil results. Teachers are responsible for monitoring the quality of assessment outcomes and making interventions to ensure every pupil is achieving their best.

Recording of Progress

This year, progress tracking will be trialled using the assessment grid located on the inside front cover of the pupil workbooks.

Progress Categories

Awarded based on the standard of work produced against set success criteria.

Pathway Level	Percentage Band	GCSE Indicative Grades
GD	80-100%	8 - 9
Exp +	60-79%	6 - 7
Exp	40-59%	4 - 5
EM +	30-39%	3
EM	10-29%	1 - 2